Reading and writing

2026-12-08 | Week 8 | Use evidence to improve a design

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Answer who, what and where questions about a selected event, then place it at the beginning, middle or end using a picture, AAC response or page detail.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Explain how a character's action affects the problem or result; answer a why or how question and point to supporting page evidence.

I Do

Read a short scene from Little Penguins. Think aloud: "Who is here? What happened? Is this at the beginning, middle or end?" Place one simple picture marker on the matching part of the sequence mat. Return to the real page to show the clue.

We Do

Reread the same scene together. Offer two clear picture choices for who/what/where; then place the scene in beginning, middle or end. Ask the Grade 4 learner how the character's action changes what happens next. Both learners use this same page and story.

You Do

Use a different scene from Little Penguins. Grade 3 answers one who/what/where prompt and sequences the event. Grade 4 explains one character action and its effect, using a page or illustration clue. Record the exact prompt, response mode and support.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Use a familiar three-picture sequence from Little Penguins: place, point to or tell what happened first, next and last. Keep a finished basket and an already-taught follow-up task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Record the question asked, the response, whether the event was placed in beginning/middle/end, the page or illustration used, and any extra prompt. This is classroom evidence; compare with an IEP goal only after the actual goal is provided.

Materials

Real books: Little Penguins. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

Little Penguins | Notice the signs of winter, the family's preparations and the penguin who chooses to stay home.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

Respond about Little Penguins: draw or select one important scene, then complete a large-print frame: "First ____. Next ____. Last ____." Offer dictation, AAC, pointing or primary writing lines.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Design a winter-weather outfit for a paper penguin and label each clothing choice. Offer it after the comprehension response or as an early-finisher activity; keep the WH pictures and sequence strip available.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Little Penguins by Cynthia Rylant. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-12-08 | Week 8 | Use evidence to improve a design

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3H

3.3H: Compare two fractions having the same numerator or denominator in problems by reasoning about their sizes and justifying the conclusion using symbols, words, objects, and pictorial models. In plain English: Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator and justify which is greater. Today: Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E

4.3A: Represent a fraction a/b as a sum of fractions 1/b, where a and b are whole numbers and b > 0, including when a > b. In plain English: Build fractions, including amounts greater than one, by adding unit fractions. 4.3B: Decompose a fraction in more than one way into a sum of fractions with the same denominator using concrete and pictorial models and recording results with symbolic representations. In plain English: Break a fraction into same-denominator sums in more than one way; show models and equations. 4.3E: Represent and solve addition and subtraction of fractions with equal denominators using objects and pictorial models that build to the number line and properties of operations. In plain English: Model and solve fraction addition and subtraction with equal denominators. Today: Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

I Do

Use Little Penguins as today's context. Compare picture groups of winter clothes or penguins with the week's fraction comparison strips. Use Little Penguins as today's context. Compare picture groups of winter clothes or penguins with the week's fraction comparison strips. Use Little Penguins as today's context. Compare picture groups of winter clothes or penguins with the week's fraction comparison strips. Grade 3: Use equal-length wholes to compare one half and one fourth. Point to the larger amount. Grade 4: Join one fourth and two fourths to make three fourths. Remove one fourth from three fourths. Build one whole plus one half.

We Do

Return to Little Penguins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: build 3/4 as 1/4 + 1/4 + 1/4 and again as 1/4 + 2/4. Record both equations and explain why the same whole and denominator stay fixed.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why. Grade 4: Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from Little Penguins that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Little Penguins | Compare picture groups of winter clothes or penguins with the week's fraction comparison strips.

Science

2026-12-08 | Week 8 | Use evidence to improve a design

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8B

3.8B: Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy. In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy. Today: Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. Today: Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

I Do

Use Little Penguins as today's context. Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely. Use Little Penguins as today's context. Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely. Use Little Penguins as today's context. Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely. Grade 3: Release the same car from a low ramp and a higher ramp. Keep the car and surface the same. Faster movement has more mechanical energy. Grade 4: Compare the same car on smooth board and felt; test a magnet near a paper clip; release a ball into a tray.

We Do

Return to Little Penguins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same. Grade 3: plan two releases of the same car, one slow and one faster, into the same lightweight foam block. Keep the car, block, surface and collision point fixed; reset the block and repeat three trials per condition. Record observed speed and how far the block moves. Use the greater observed effect as evidence about mechanical energy; do not use travel distance alone as a speed measurement.

You Do

Grade 3: Identify the observed faster run and point to evidence. Grade 4: Show friction, magnetic attraction or gravity using observed evidence.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Toy car, board, felt, ramp, tape, fraction strips, project board, curriculum history pictures. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from Little Penguins that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Little Penguins | Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely.

Social studies

2026-12-08 | Week 8 | Use evidence to improve a design

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9C

3.9C: Identify and describe individual acts of civic responsibility, including obeying laws, serving and improving the community, serving on a jury, and voting. In plain English: Describe civic responsibilities such as following laws, helping the community, jury service and voting. Today: Explain an action that improves a community.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3D

4.3D: Describe the successes, problems, and organizations of the Republic of Texas such as the establishment of a constitution, economic struggles, relations with American Indians, and the Texas Rangers. In plain English: Describe the Republic of Texas's successes, problems and organizations. Today: Explain a challenge faced by the Republic.

I Do

Use Little Penguins as today's context. Recognize that family members can make different choices and identify ways a community prepares for cooler weather. Use Little Penguins as today's context. Recognize that family members can make different choices and identify ways a community prepares for cooler weather. Use Little Penguins as today's context. Recognize that family members can make different choices and identify ways a community prepares for cooler weather. Grade 3: Explain an action that improves a community. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Explain a challenge faced by the Republic. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to Little Penguins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. G3 community solution; G4 historical action/leader. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Explain an action that improves a community. Grade 4: Explain a challenge faced by the Republic. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from Little Penguins that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Little Penguins | Recognize that family members can make different choices and identify ways a community prepares for cooler weather.